

“Open source technology will bring in a services-based model with a reasonable opex and zero capex”



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myOpenSourceStore.com is an open source solutions provider catering to businesses worldwide.

Devasia Kurian, managing director, myOpenSourceStore.com interacted with **Ashwin Gopinath of OSFY** about the reason behind starting the online open source portal and what it means for the future of open source in India.

What is happening with open source technology w.r.t. businesses and organisations?

The adoption rate is low in comparison with proprietary alternatives; but there is pressure on enterprises to meet customer requirements with fewer resources and to find cost-effective solutions with a quick ROI. So the use of open source technology is increasing.

OSS facilitates the preservation of a wide range of information for future developments and it comes with considerable financial savings. Government institutes and PSUs are looking forward to more adoption and implementation of OSS in their IT infrastructure. The increasing awareness of open source in the public and government sector has been one of the significant developments in IT technology.

How is open source affecting the commercial software business model?

As we know, a liberal licensing policy makes open source software accessible free of charge, along with the source code, which can then be customised by the user as per requirements. This drastically reduces costs, ensures less vendor dependence, reduces piracy/copyright infringements and increases the growth of a knowledge-based society.

The key advantages open source offers are: no vendor lock-in, abundant support, simple licence management, cost effectiveness and easy customisation.

Open source technology will revolutionise the current

software business model by replacing the existing software vendors who deploy a large capex-based model. Open source technology will bring in a services-based model with a reasonable opex and zero capex. The industry will welcome this movement whole-heartedly.

What are some of the considerations for a company deciding to move over to the open source side?

Before a company decides to adopt and implement open source technology in a system, it needs to understand the long-term implication on the business. Since the decision to shift to open source is a long-term objective and incurs costs, the company needs to evaluate multiple factors.

Some of them are:

- Does the software offer sufficient features for the near future?
- Will it scale up based on the organisation's requirements?
- Is there adequate documentation on installation, configuration and trouble shooting?
- Will the service provider offer support on installation, configuration and maintenance, and...
- Is there a large online community supporting the software?

Does the open source approach have any drawbacks for organisations?

Though open source software is free software, which can be modified, customised and is cost effective, there are certain limitations.